

You can access a demo of Moodle on its home page. Moodle offers distinct controls for each of its user classes – Manager, Teacher and Pupils. The Admin view, besides allowing changes to the site structure, also allows editing courseware parameters such as courses and their durations, enrolment schedules and grading. The Teacher view allows authorised teachers to create course content (or lessons), interact with users in real time through chat, create tests and quizzes and grade performance. The Student view allows users to access lessons and participate in tests created by teachers. The Chat module also allows real time interaction with the teacher.



For more open source course management systems go to [www.edutools.info/feature\\_list.jsp?pj=4&f=823](http://www.edutools.info/feature_list.jsp?pj=4&f=823)

Since the student using Moodle need not be on the campus to use the resources, Moodle is apt for distance education as well. With distance education gaining in popularity, applications such as Moodle are sure to become indispensable in the education sector.

Moodle offers a bewildering array of features and can be converted into a powerful tool to manage courseware. But, as previously stated, to achieve this users need some form of training.

### 2.3.3 Library management systems

Though libraries are part of an educational institution, we can include public libraries in this discussion. In fact, any lending library following the same procedure (be it books or video DVDs) can be included.

The beauty of a library management system will be appreciated when one trudges all the way to the library only to return empty handed because the last copy of a book/DVD had been lent out. If an application would allow the availability of a book/DVD to be searched from the comfort of your home, it would be good. In fact, even better would be a single portal to search for a book/DVD across many libraries! An LMS is the answer to such needs.

Evergreen (<http://www.open-ils.org>)

To appreciate the power of Evergreen, one has to only visit